Supreme Court. A Senior Advocate is not entitled to appear in the Supreme Court without an Advocate-on-Record.

A Permanent Committee has been constituted by the Chief Justice of India to deal with all matters relating to designation of Senior Advocates in the Supreme Court. The composition of the Committee is as under: (a) Chief Justice of India-Chairperson; (b) Two seniormost Judges of the Supreme Court-Members; (c) Attorney General for India-Member; and (d) A member of the Bar as nominated by the Chairperson and Members of this Committee.

2. Advocate-on-Record

An 'Advocate-on-Record' means an advocate, who is entitled under the Supreme Court Rules, 2013 to act as well as to plead for a party in the Supreme Court. No Advocate other than an Advocate-on-Record is entitled to file an appearance or act for a party in the Supreme Court.

The Supreme Court at the time of its inception in 1950 inherited the jurisdiction of the Federal Court and the Privy Council. The Rules prevalent in the Federal Court were continued in the beginning. The Practice and Procedure of the Supreme Court has undergone enormous changes ever since. Originally, the Rules of the Supreme Court (as then adopted) recognized the system of "Agents". The Practice and Procedure was substantially modified in the year 1954 and "Advocates-on-Record" replaced the system of "Agents". When introduced in 1954, apart from the then registered "Agents", an Advocate of seven years standing was entitled to get himself/herself registered as an 'Advocate-on-Record', provided he/she fulfilled the conditions prescribed.

In 1959, the Rules were amended, introducing the 'Advocate-on-Record' examination conducted by the Supreme Court. The Registry of the Supreme Court conducts Advocate-on-Record Examination periodically with approval of the Examination Committee and under the supervision of Secretary, Board of Examiners, appointed by the Chief Justice of India. The examination maintains high standards to ensure that best of the talent come in as Advocate-on-Record. A Regulation pertaining to the examination states that no Advocate shall be eligible to appear in the examination unless he/she has received training from an Advocate-on-Record of not less than ten years standing for a continuous period of one year commencing from the end of the fourth year of date of his/her enrolment.

3. Other Advocates

These are Advocates whose names are entered on the roll of any State Bar Council maintained under the Advocates Act, 1961. They cannot appear, plead and address the Court in any matter on behalf of a party in the Supreme Court unless instructed by an Advocate-on-Record or permitted by the Court.

Table 69.1 Name and Jurisdiction of State Bar Councils

Sl. No.	Name	States & UTs Covered
1.	Bar Council of Andhra Pradesh	Andhra Pradesh
2.	Bar Council of Bihar	Bihar